

Solution: We shall list out all perfect powers less than 100.

$a=2: 1=1^2, 4=2^2, 9=3^2, 16=4^2, 25=5^2, 36=6^2, 49=7^2, 64=8^2, 81=9^2$
 $a=3: 1=1^3, 8=2^3, 27=3^3, \cancel{64=4^3}$
 $a=4: 1=1^4, 16=2^4, 81=3^4$
 $a=5: 1=1^5, 32=2^5$
 $a=6: 1=1^6, 64=2^6$

In ascending order, the perfect powers are: 1, 4, 8, 9, 16, 25, 27, 32, 36, 49, 64, 81. From this list, it's easy to verify that 8 and 9 are the only consecutive positive integers less than 100 which are perfect powers. $\square$

Proof by cases: A proof by cases must cover all possible cases that arise in

a theorem.

Example 3: Prove that if n is an integer, then $n^2 \geq n$.

Solution: Since n is an integer, it can either be positive ($n > 0$), or negative ($n < 0$) or zero ($n = 0$).

Case 1: $n > 0$. Since n is an integer, $\therefore n \geq 1$. $\therefore n \cdot n \geq n \cdot 1 \Rightarrow n^2 \geq n$

Case 2: $n < 0$. Since n is an integer, $\therefore n \leq -1$. We know, $\forall n \in \mathbb{R}$, $n^2 \geq 0$. $\therefore n^2 \geq n$ for all negatives

Case 3: $n = 0$. $n^2 = 0 \cdot 0 = 0 = n$. So, $n^2 \geq n$ holds. for $n = 0$.

$\therefore$ We conclude that if n is an integer, then $n^2 \geq n$. $\square$

Example 4: Use a proof by cases to show that $|xy| = |x||y|$, where x and y are real numbers. (Recall that $|a|$, the absolute value of a , equals a when $a \geq 0$ and equals $-a$ when $a < 0$).